

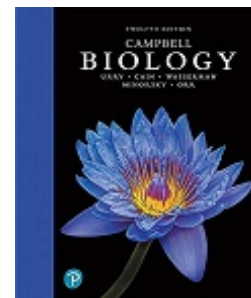
Biology 1202

General Biology Lecture

COMPLETE SYLLABUS

Sections 2, 3, and 4 “LIVE”

Fall 2026



Instructor: Dr. Adam W. Hrincevich (just “Adam” please...)

Email: zohrin@lsu.edu, I will answer all valid emails during the week (Mon-Fri, 9 AM-5 PM CST) within 24 hours. If your question is something that has been addressed via a mass class email, detailed on MOODLE, or outlined in our course syllabus, do not expect a quick reply. **NOTE: The ONLY email that I use is zohrin@lsu.edu; others will not be read/opened. Email is the easiest and fastest way to reach me, or see me before/after class.**

Office: 366 Life Sciences Bldg.

Office Hours: By appointment on Tuesdays/Thursday. Please email me as this is the fastest and most efficient way to reach me. I am also available by appointment via [ZOOM](#) (which is more flexible for specific days/times , but I am available via email almost 24/7.

SI Leader: Ravyn Thomas, rtho223@lsu.edu. Office Hours and location TBA.

Lecture:	Section 2:	1:30-2:50 PM	Tuesday & Thursday	0101 OLOL ISB
	Section 3:	3:00-4:20 PM	Tuesday & Thursday	0101 OLOL ISB
	Section 4	12:00-1:20 PM	Tuesday & Thursday	228 Tureaud Hall

Exams: 4 exams All exams are taken at the [LSU Testing Center](#) located in Himes Hall. If you are not able to take your exams on campus, you should sign up for a different section of BIOL 1202. More information about this is discussed below.

Text: REQUIRED Urry et al. 2020. Campbell Biology, 12th ed. Pearson Publishing Company. Available in the LSU bookstore as a **custom packaged edition** that includes the **MASTERING BIOLOGY ACCESS CODE** (which you will need). Pricing for the textbook will vary, depending on where you purchase it. Historically, materials purchased through www.MasteringBiology.com will be the cheapest.

If you are planning on purchasing your textbook from another source, MAKE SURE that your text includes the MASTERING BIOLOGY ACCESS CODE. There will be quizzes and homework assignments posted to the MASTERING BIOLOGY website, and in order to access this information, you will require an access code. Accordingly, 10% of your overall average in BIOL 1202 will be based on these activities (quizzes and homeworks). We are **NOT** using the virtual labs in Mastering Biology.

Our Course ID for Mastering Biology is: **hrincevich93563**

For more information about how to register for Mastering Biology, please see the registration instructions at the end of the syllabus. Mastering Biology is a required component of the course and accounts for 10% of your grade in this course. You should already have an account set up for Mastering Biology if you took BIOL 1201. Mastering Biology subscriptions are typically active for 18 months after initial activation/creation. If you already have a Mastering Biology account, you will still need to “join this course” using our course ID listed above.

ILC: This course (BIOL 1202) satisfies the LSU Integrative Learning Core (ILC) requirement. Integrated learning allows students to make simple connections among ideas and experiences and across disciplines and perspectives. The ILC curriculum is designed to develop student abilities to transfer their learning to new situations, and demonstrate a sense of self as a learner. A fundamental goal of the ILC is to foster

students' practical and intellectual capacities associated with integrative learning in preparation for high competence and functionality in their post-baccalaureate careers. This course fulfills the BOR area of *Natural Sciences* and provides students experience with the ILC proficiency of *inquiry and analysis*.

EXPECTATIONS: This is a 3 hour credit course this semester. It is expected that you will spend *at least* 9 hours per week reading assignments, completing online quiz/homework assignments, studying lecture notes, and preparing for examinations. This 9 hour expectation is considered a minimum. In order to do well in this course, you should devote consistent blocks of time each week during which you can focus on BIOL 1202 material. It is also expected that you have a solid foundation from topics covered in BIOL 1201 (or equivalent course). We will NOT be re-covering or reviewing these areas during lecture.

Learning Objectives for BIOL 1202: We will discuss a broad range of topics in BIOL 1202. By the end of the semester, we will have addressed the learning objectives summarized below:

1. Apply the scientific method in lab experiences to interpret information and draw conclusions.
2. Demonstrate an understanding of the impact of science on society.
3. Demonstrate an understanding of the principles of scientific inquiry.
4. Demonstrate the ability to make connections between concepts across biology.
5. Demonstrate the ability to think critically and employ critical thinking skills.
6. Demonstrate the quantitative skills needed to succeed in biology.
7. Evaluate the credibility of scientific information from various sources.
8. Read and interpret graphs and data.

MOODLE: The MOODLE page for our course will post all of the class materials including notes, review sheets, grades, etc. **Be sure to check this page regularly.** If you have your email forwarded to another address, make sure that account can accept emails with large attachments. If you are not receiving emails from me on a regular basis, then your forwarded email is not set up properly.

Exam Information: The exams will be based on the topics in the assigned readings. Questions will not be word-for-word from the text or notes, so understanding the concepts is critical. This is not a course in memorizing facts. As a science major, you should be able to synthesize biological concepts, understand how things work together, and how mechanisms achieve certain goals or endpoints. The format for the exams is generally M/C, matching, true/false, labeling pictures/diagrams, etc. The course is designed to follow and complement the book chapters, and some of the lecture material may not be in the text. Therefore, it is essential that you complete the assigned readings when preparing for the exams. Overall, each chapter is covered in depth.

Exam Format: All exams will be administered through the LSU Testing Center located on-campus in Himes Hall. If you are not able to take exams on campus, you should sign up for a different section of BIOL 1202. There will NOT be any alternate testing format offered this semester. For more information about the LSU Testing Center, please visit their website. More information about exam scheduling will be discussed once the LSU drop/add period is over and class testing rosters are loaded.

There will be four (4) exams taken in this class, each with ~75-100 questions. You will be able to calculate your grade in the class at any time through MOODLE. Immediately at the end of your exam session, you will be shown your score. Realize that each exam is drawn from a huge pool of questions and your test will not have the same exact questions as others. A photo ID (LSU ID, driver's license, state ID card or passport) is absolutely required for each and every exam. Be sure to bring one form of ID to the computer lab for each exam! **You will not be allowed to take an exam without proper ID.**

ALL EXAMS FOR THIS COURSE WILL BE COMPUTER-BASED AND TAKEN AT THE LSU TESTING CENTER ON CAMPUS. EXAMS CAN BE SCHEDULED USING THE LINKS IN MOODLE AND TYPICALLY HAVE A 3-DAY WINDOW IN WHICH THEY ARE OFFERED

All exams will be taken in Himes Hall. Exams will only be available during the scheduled time period (see syllabus for exact dates). A web-based scheduler will allow you to schedule your exam time and this scheduler will be available for the entire semester starting the week after the add period, if not sooner.

You must schedule an exam before taking it.

If you fail to schedule and/or take an exam without a valid excuse you will receive a zero.

Immediately at the end of your exam session, you will be shown your score. Realize that each exam is drawn from a huge pool of questions and your test will not have the same exact questions as others.

Review Materials: I will provide you with exam review materials and/or links for you to create exam review materials prior to our exams. That way, you can assess your mastery of the material before you are tested on that information. Our textbook and Mastering Biology have a plethora of review materials available to students. This would include practice tests, vocabulary review, flash cards, etc.

Exam Dates: Our exam dates are listed below and are firm. **If you are not able to take the exams during one of the days within the exam window, you should NOT ENROLL IN THIS COURSE. These exam dates and times are FIRM.** There will NOT be alternate testing dates/times unless you have a University approved excuse and made prior arrangements with me before the exam.

EXAM 1:	WED thru FRI	9/16 thru 9/18
EXAM 2:	WED thru FRI	10/14 thru 10/16
EXAM 3:	MON thru WED	11/9 thru 11/11
EXAM 4:	MON thru THUR	12/7 thru 12/10

Missed Exams: There will be **NO** make-up exams except for pre-approved, University-approved absences, and any un-excused absence will be scored as a zero (0%). You need to fill out and return to me a “**BIOL 1202 MISSED EXAM FORM**” (located in MOODLE). If you do not fill out and return to me via email (do **NOT** place it under my office door) the BIOL 1202 MISSED EXAM FORM **within 24 hours of missing your exam**, you will have a zero (0%) posted for that exam. Arrangements to take the make-up exam must be made with me within 48 hours of missing the exam. If you know that you will miss an exam due to a pre-approved University Approved Absence, you should make arrangements with me as far in advance as possible **BEFORE** missing the exam. ***Make-up exams may be essay, short answer, fill-in-the-blank questions, or a computer exam.*** Missed exams without a University Approved absence will be considered on an case-by-case basis depending on individual circumstances. Make-up exams offered in these instances without a University Approved absence will be penalized a **MINIMUM of 10%**, depending on the circumstances and are at the discretion of the Instructor. Bottom line is that if you miss an exam and do NOT have a University Approved absence, you will earn a zero.

Quiz & Homework Information: The quizzes and homework assignments (which will be assigned through MOODLE and the MASTERING BIOLOGY website) given throughout the semester will be based on the topics in the assigned readings. The purpose of the quizzes and homework assignments is two-fold. First, they reinforce the concepts covered in the lecture notes and help you prepare for the exam. Secondly, they are basically a boost to your grade if you make sure to complete them by the assigned date. Quizzes and homework assignments will be posted to MOODLE and/or the MASTERING BIOLOGY website, and you will generally have 5-10 days to complete them. Once the quiz/homework assignment closes out on the due date, answers will become available and scores posted to MOODLE.

I will **NOT** extend the due dates for these assignments once they close out under any circumstances.

THERE WILL BE NO MAKE-UP QUIZZES or HOMEWORKS OFFERED, EVEN WITH A UNIVERSITY APPROVED ABSENCE SINCE ANSWERS ARE POSTED IMMEDIATELY AFTER THE ASSIGNMENT CLOSES OUT

I will drop 10 % of the lowest homework/quiz scores in calculating your homework/quiz average. You will be required to take 90% of all homeworks/quizzes. For example, if we have a total of 100 homework/quiz assignments during the semester, you can drop your 10 lowest scores (any combination of homeworks and quizzes) in calculating your average. In the case where we had a total of 100 homeworks/quizzes and you only took 89 of them, one of your scores will be a zero which will ultimately lower your quiz average.

Grading Scale: Your grade will consist of two components: 4 exams (weighted equally and based on a perfect score of 100%) and your Mastering Biology cumulative homework/quiz average.

4 EXAMS = 90% of your grade (22.5% for each of the four exams)
Homework/Quiz average = 10% of your grade (lowest 10% dropped)

Score	Grade	Score	Grade	Score	Grade	Score	Grade	Score	Grade
98.0 - 100	A+	88.0 - 89.9	B+	78.0 - 79.9	C+	68.0 - 69.9	D+	0 - 59.9 %	F
92.0 - 97.9	A	82.0 - 87.9	B	72.0 - 77.9	C	62.0 - 67.9	D		
90.0 - 91.9	A-	80.0 - 81.9	B-	70.0 - 71.9	C-	60.0 - 61.9	D-		

Problems in the Course: If, after studying the notes and text thoroughly, you are still having problems in this class, please send me an email or call me. Don't wait until just before an exam, since you won't have enough time to completely understand the material. Additionally, we have a SI (Supplemental Instruction) Leader for our course. This SI Leader is a student who has taken this course before and has extensive experience in the topics we will cover this semester. These SI Leaders will answer student questions, have review sessions, hold office hours, etc. Essentially, they are an extension of myself and an excellent resource to help get you through the course. Another resource is the Center for Academic Success. They offer programs, seminars, handouts, and personal consultations for study and note-taking improvements, test-taking strategies, surviving-the-semester hints. Check out their website (<https://www.lsu.edu/cas/index.php>) for more information.

Schedule: Below is the planned order of chapters we will cover this semester. This schedule is subject to change based on University closures, weather events, etc. I have not assigned specific dates to chapters, but we generally cover 1-2 chapters a week, depending on the length of the chapter and ancillary materials I will provide to you.

SELECTED TOPICS TO COVER FOR FALL 2026

CH 22	Descent With Modification: A Darwinian View of Life
CH 23	Evolution of Populations
CH 24	Origin of Species
CH 25	History of Life on Earth
CH 26	Phylogeny and the Tree of Life
CH 27	Bacteria and Archaea
CH 19	Viruses

CH 28	Protists
CH 29	Plant Diversity I: How Plants Colonized Land
CH 30	Plant Diversity II: The Evolution of Seed Plants
CH 31	Fungi
CH 32	An Overview of Animal Diversity
CH 33	An Introduction to Invertebrates
CH 34	The Origin and Evolution of Vertebrates
CH 40	Basic Principles of Animal Form and Function
CH 41	Animal Nutrition
CH 42	Circulation and Gas Exchange
CH 47	Animal Development
CH 50	Sensory and Motor Mechanisms

IMPORTANT DATES		
DATE	DAY(s)	WHY IT'S IMPORTANT
8/24	MON	First day of classes
9/2	WED	Last day to drop classes without a "W"
9/2	WED	Last day to add classes
9/7	MON	Labor Day Holiday (no classes)
9/16 thru 9/18	WED-FRI	EXAM #1 window (schedule ASAP)
10/8 thru 10/9	THUR-FRI	Fall Holiday (no classes)
10/14 thru 10/16	WED-FRI	EXAM #2 window (schedule ASAP)
10/20	TUES	Midterm grades due
11/6	FRI	Last day to drop courses with a "W", Last day to resign from LSU
11/9 thru 11/11	MON-WED	EXAM #3 window (schedule ASAP)
11/25 thru 11/27	WED-FRI	Thanksgiving Holiday (no classes)
12/4	FRI	Last day of classes
12/7 thru 12/10	MON-THUR	EXAM #4 window (schedule ASAP)

* Exam dates/coverage are subject to change if necessary; based on University closures or weather events

ATTENDANCE IS CRITICAL TO YOUR SUCCESS IN THIS COURSE!!!

